

## JULIE M. E. PEDERSEN

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### EDUCATION

- 2024-present     **PhD Psychology**, *University of Edinburgh*, Edinburgh, UK.
- 2023-2024       **MSc Psychological Research** with Distinction, *University of Edinburgh*, Edinburgh, UK.
- 2019-2023       **BSc Psychology** with 1<sup>st</sup> Class Honours, *University of Edinburgh*, Edinburgh, UK.

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### Research Positions

- 2025-present     **Lab Manager**, *The Human Decision-Making Lab*, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.
- 2025-present     **Research Contractor with Survey Team** [part-time], *Rethink Priorities*, San Francisco, California, US.
- June-July 2025   **Research Contractor with Worldview Investigations Team** [full-time], *Rethink Priorities*, San Francisco, California, US.
- 2021-2023       **Research Assistant**, *The Human Decision-Making Lab*, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.
- June-Aug 2022   **Carnegie Trust Summer Vacation Scholar**, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.
- 2021              **Research Assistant**, *Syddansk Universitet*, Odense, Denmark

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### PUBLICATIONS

#### Peer Reviewed Articles (\* indicates joint first authorship)

**Pedersen**, J. M. E., Wilks, M., Doumas, A., & Moore, A. (under review). Moralization by Analogy: A Novel Perspective on Moral Change. *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Navarre, N.\*, **Pedersen**, J. M. E.\*, & Moore, A. (2025). Political Polarization and Fractionalisation from Rational Values-Based Inference in an Agent-Based Graph Network.

*Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.* <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/6gv6j71v>

**Pedersen, J. M. E., & Loughnan, S.** (2024). Dissociation of dairy from its animal origin and the role of disgust to reduce dairy consumption. *Psychology of Human-Animal Inter-group Relations*, 3, Article e10387. <https://doi.org/10.5964/phair.10387>

**Pedersen, J. M. E., & Moore, A.** (2023). Simulating political polarisation as a function of uncertain signalling of moral values. *Proceedings of the 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.* <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/0d143859>

Ithurburn, A., Moore, A., & **Pedersen, J. M. E.** (2025). Power motivations and risk preferences. *Sage Open*, 15(3), 21582440251363317. <https://doi.org/10.1177/21582440251363317>

## Theses

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (August 2024). “A formalised theory of political polarisation as uncertain identity inference and signalling supported by moral values”. MSc Thesis, University of Edinburgh.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (May 2023). “Dissociation of dairy from its animal origin and the role of disgust to reduce dairy consumption”. Undergraduate dissertation, University of Edinburgh.

## Talks (\* indicates joint first authorship)

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), Wilks, M., Dumas, A., & Moore, A. (November 2025). *Moralization by Analogy: Analogical Reasoning as a Mechanism for Moral Change*. Research talk presented at Social Psychology Seminar Series at the University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), Wilks, M., Dumas, A., & Moore, A. (November 2025). *Moralization by Analogy: Analogical Reasoning as a Mechanism for Moral Change*. Research talk presented to the Human-Decision Making Lab, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), Wilks, M., Dumas, A., & Moore, A. (October 2025). *Moralization by Analogy: Analogical Reasoning as a Mechanism for Moral Change*. Research talk presented to the Cognition, Computation, and Development Lab, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), Wilks, M., Dumas, A., & Moore, A. (April 2025). *Moralization as Analogical Reasoning*. Research talk presented to the Altruistic Minds Lab, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (co-presenter)\*, & Deligianni, A. (co-presenter)\* (November 2024). *Introduction to Null Hypothesis Significance Testing: Uses and Misuses for Machine Learning*. Informatics Equality, Diversity, and Inclusion Reading Group, University of Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), & Loughnan, S. (November 2024). *Udderly Disgusting! Investigating Disgust as a Dairy Consumption Reduction Pathway*. Online research talk presented at the monthly meeting of the Researchers for Ending Consumption of Animal Products (RECAP).

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), & Loughnan, S. (November 2024). *Udderly Disgusting! Investigating Disgust as a Dairy Consumption Reduction Pathway*. Research talk presented to the Altruistic Minds Lab, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), & Moore, A. (October 2024). *Moral Values as a Mediator of Political Identity Signalling. A Computational Modelling Approach*. Research talk presented at Social Psychology Seminar Series at the University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), & Moore, A. (October 2024). *A formalised theory of political polarisation as uncertain identity inference and signalling supported by moral values*. Chalk talk presented to the Cognition, Computation, and Development Lab, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), & Moore, A. (September 2024). *Simulating Political polarization as a function of uncertain inference and signaling of moral values*. Research talk presented to the Human-Decision Making Lab, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK

**Pedersen, J. M. E.** (presenter), & Moore, A. (July 2023). *Simulating Political polarization as a function of uncertain inference and signaling of moral values*. Research talk presented at the 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Melbourne, Australia.

**Pedersen, J. M. E.**, & Moore, A. (presenter) (October 2022). *Modelling political polarisation with uncertain signalling of moral values*. Presented at Social Psychology Seminar Series at the University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK.

**Posters** (\* indicates joint first authorship)

Navarre, N.\* (presenter), **Pedersen**, J. M. E.\*, & Moore, A. (July 2025). *Political Polarization and Fractionalisation from Rational Values-Based Inference in an Agent-Based Graph Network*. Poster presented at the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, San Francisco, USA.

**Pedersen**, J. M. E. (presenter), & Moore, A. (April 2025). *Moral values as uncertain identity inference and signaling supported by moral values*. Poster presented at the Symposium on Opinion Shift, Social Influence, and External Manipulation, Edinburgh, UK.

**Pedersen**, J. M. E. (presenter), & Moore, A. (February 2025). *Moral values as uncertain identity inference and signaling supported by moral values*. Poster presented at the Annual Convention of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Denver, Colorado, US.

**Pedersen**, J. M. E. (presenter), & Moore, A. (February 2025). *Moral values as a mechanism for political polarization: an agent-based modeling approach*. Poster presented at the Political Psychology Pre-Conference at the Annual Convention of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Denver, Colorado, US.

**Pedersen**, J. M. E. (presenter), & Moore, A. (July 2024). *Uncertain identity inference in a biased media landscape: an agent-based model of identity signalling, moral values, and political polarisation*. Poster presented at the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, the Netherlands.

**Pedersen**, J. M. E. (presenter), & Moore, A. (February 2024). *Moral values as signals of political identity under uncertainty: an agent-based model approach*. Poster presented at the Moral Psychology Pre-Conference at the Annual Convention of the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, San Diego, California, US.

**Pedersen**, J. M. E., & Moore, A. (September 2022). *Modelling political polarisation with uncertain signalling of moral values*. Poster presented at the Carnegie Trust Vacation Scholar Poster Competition, Edinburgh, UK.

## Blog Posts

Rethink Priorities, **Pedersen**, J. M. E., & Moss, D. (2025, December 4). EA Survey 2024: Cause prioritization. *Effective Altruism Forum*. <https://forum.effectivealtruism.org/posts/CKwDgZGLipchAoxTN/ea-survey-2024-cause-prioritization>

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## AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2023-2027      Scottish Graduate School of Social Sciences, 1+ 3-year PhD Studentship (~ £98,550).

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| 2022 | The Carnegie Trust – Universities of Scotland, Summer Vacation Scholarship Programme (£4,158).                    |
| 2024 | Drever Prize for the best overall student on a Psychology degree programme, for the academic year 2022/23 (£200). |
| 2023 | Margaret Donaldson Prize for best Undergraduate Psychology Dissertation poster (£40).                             |
| 2022 | Year 3 Psychology Achievement Prize for best overall marks in Psychology year 3 (£50).                            |
| 2021 | J M Brunskill Prize for best overall mark in Data Analysis for Psychology in R 2 (£100).                          |
| 2020 | Certificate of Merit for best overall mark in Psychology 1A.                                                      |

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## TEACHING

### *University of Edinburgh 2025/26*

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| PSYL10102 | Critical Analysis, <i>course tutor and marker</i> .                                   |
| PSYL11098 | Multivariate Statistics and Methodology using R, <i>lab demonstrator and marker</i> . |

### *University of Edinburgh 2024/25*

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| INFR10054 | Computational Cognitive Science, <i>course tutor</i> .                                |
| PSYL11098 | Multivariate Statistics and Methodology using R, <i>lab demonstrator and marker</i> . |

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## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2024-present **Ad hoc reviewer**

*Cognition, Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.*

March 2026 **Panel member**, How to write an abstract

*Undergraduate Psychology Association (UPA)*

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## COMMUNITY SERVICE

|              |                                                                                                            |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025-present | <b>Co-organizer</b> , <i>Social Psychology Seminar Series</i> , University of Edinburgh.                   |
| 2025-present | <b>Co-organizer</b> , <i>PhD CommuniTea</i> , University of Edinburgh.                                     |
| 2023-2024    | <b>PG Representative</b> , <i>Psychology Community and Research Association</i> , University of Edinburgh. |

- 2021-2023      **Reading and Discussion Group Coordinator**, *University of Edinburgh Psychology Society*.
- 2020-2023      **Department Head of Social Sciences**, *Edinburgh Scientific Researchers Association (ESRA)*.
- 2022            **Co-founder and Head of Psychology Community and Research Association**, *Subcommittee in the University of Edinburgh Psychology Society*.
- 2020-2021      **President**, *University of Edinburgh Psychology Society*.
- 2020-2021      **Peer Support Leader**, *PPLS Student Community Council*, University of Edinburgh.
- 2020-2021      **Session Leader**, *Economics Peer-Assisted Learning Scheme*, University of Edinburgh.